Society of Technological Studies
Department of Physical Sciences and Technology
Faculty of Applied Sciences
Sabaragamuwa University of Sri Lanka

SYNTHEX 2026

Pitch Competition Guidelines

Introduction

SYNTHEX 2026 is an innovation and pitch competition organized by the Society of Technological Studies (STS), Department of Physical Sciences and Technology, Faculty of Applied Sciences, Sabaragamuwa University of Sri Lanka.

The competition aims to encourage students to identify real-world problems, develop innovative solutions, and present their ideas in the fields of Chemistry, Physics, and Computer Science. It provides a platform for students to demonstrate their creativity, technical knowledge, problem-solving abilities, and innovative thinking.

Eligibility

a) The competition is open to all students of the Department of Physical Sciences and Technology, Faculty of Applied Sciences, Sabaragamuwa University of Sri Lanka.
b) Students may participate individually or as a team.
c) Each team may consist of a maximum of six members.
d) All team members must belong to the Department of Physical Sciences and Technology.

Competition Categories

Participants may submit innovative ideas related to any of the following subject areas:

- **Chemistry:** Innovations involving chemical sciences, materials, chemical processes, environmental chemistry, and related applications.
- **Physics:** Innovations involving physical sciences, electronics, energy, instrumentation, applied physics, and related applications.
- **Computer Science:** Innovations involving software development, artificial intelligence, machine learning, information technology, data science, and related applications.

***Ideas combining multiple subject areas are also welcome**.

Terms and Conditions

a) All submitted ideas must be original and developed by the participating individual or team.
b) Participants must ensure that their submissions do not infringe upon the intellectual property rights of others.
c) Each individual or team must submit a concept paper following the structure provided by the organizers.
d) All information provided during registration and submission must be accurate and complete.
e) Participants must comply with all rules and instructions issued by the organizing committee.
f) The organizing committee reserves the right to reject submissions that do not meet the competition requirements.
g) Any form of plagiarism, false information, or unethical conduct may result in disqualification.

Application and Idea Submission Process

a) Participants must submit their ideas through the official SYNTHEX 2026 website.
b) Each individual or team must complete the required submission details and upload a concept paper.
c) The concept paper must follow the prescribed structure and word limits.
d) The deadline for idea submission is 15 November 2026.
e) All submitted ideas will undergo an initial evaluation by appointed evaluation panel.
f) Selected participants will be notified and invited to participate in the final pitch competition.

Concept Paper Structure

Participants must prepare their concept papers using the following structure:

No.	Required section	Word limit
1	Title of the Project	—
2	Individual/Team Details (names, year of study, contact number and email)	—
3	What Idea are you addressing?	Maximum 100 words
4	Briefly explain your idea or innovation.	Maximum 100 words
5	Who benefits and how?	Maximum 50 words

Important: Participants must follow the given structure and word limits when preparing their concept papers.

Competition Procedure

The competition will be conducted through the following stages:

Stage 1 – Idea Submission

Participants submit their innovative ideas through the SYNTHEX 2026 website before the submission deadline.

Stage 2 – Initial Evaluation and Selection

Submitted concept papers will be reviewed by an appointed evaluation panel. Selected individuals or teams will advance to the intermediate selection round.

Stage 3 – Intermediate Selection Round (Video Submission)

Selected participants must submit a 5-minute video demonstrating their proposed concept or innovation. Shortlisted participants will advance to the final pitch competition.

Stage 4 – Final Pitch Competition

Shortlisted participants will present their ideas before a panel of judges. Participants must explain their proposed innovations and demonstrate the concept through a live presentation.

Stage 5 – Evaluation and Winner Selection

The judges will evaluate the presentations according to the established judging criteria and select the winners.

Pitch Presentation Guidelines

a) Each shortlisted individual or team will be given an opportunity to present their proposed innovation.
b) Each participant or team will be allocated 5–7 minutes for the presentation.
c) An additional 3–5 minutes will be allocated for questions from the judging panel.
d) Participants are encouraged to use presentation slides, prototypes, models, simulations, or other suitable demonstration methods to explain their ideas.
e) A fully developed or commercially available product is not mandatory. Participants may present an innovative concept supported by a demonstration or proof of concept.
f) All team members are encouraged to contribute to the presentation.
g) Participants must adhere to the allocated presentation time.

Evaluation and Assessment

The judging panel will evaluate the submitted ideas and final presentations based on the following proposed criteria:

Evaluation criteria	Weight
Innovation and Originality	20%
Problem Identification and Relevance	15%
Technical Feasibility	15%
Practical Application and Impact	15%
Demonstration / Proof of Concept	15%
Presentation and Communication	10%
Responses to Judges' Questions	10%
Total	100%

The judging panel reserves the right to make the final decisions regarding the evaluation and selection of winners.

Awards and Recognition

a) All participants who take part in the competition will receive a certificate of participation.
b) Winners of the competition will receive additional certificates of achievement in recognition of their accomplishments.
c) The organizing committee reserves the right to announce additional awards or recognitions, if applicable.

Contact Information

For further information and inquiries regarding SYNTHEX 2026, participants may contact the organizing committee through the official communication channels provided on the SYNTHEX 2026 website (www.synthex2026.live).